

## **HELPPBNK STEP 24 - SET DATA-COST AND LIMIT GUARDRAILS BEFORE WIDER PUSH**

Date: February 21, 2026

### **OBJECTIVE**

Ensure scale readiness by controlling data spend and preventing service degradation.

### **GUARDRAIL REQUIREMENTS**

1. Hard request caps per user/plan
2. Source-specific rate limits
3. Queuing + fallback path when external feeds fail
4. Friendly user messages for delays/limits

### **COST CONTROLS**

1. Target max data cost per active user
2. Weekly spend review by provider
3. Alert thresholds for abnormal usage
4. Rapid rollback plan for cost spikes

### **OUTPUT**

1. Cost guardrail policy
2. Dashboard snapshot (cost per scan/user)
3. Signoff before broader launch campaigns